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NO. 23

MEMORANDUM OF THE PRESS AND RADIO NEWS CONFERENCE, WEDNESDAY, JUNE 28, 1950

UNITED STATES MOVES IN KOREAN SITUATION

Secretary Acheson at his press and radio news conference this morning made a short statement covering the world reaction to President Truman's statement on the United States action in the Korean situation, the decision to take the matter to the United Nations, the Security Council's cease-fire order, the unity of thought among the Government department heads and presidential advisers, and the favorable reaction to the United States decision in the American press and radio. (See Press Release No. 691)

Secretary Acheson, when asked if we had heard from the Russians, replied that we had not received any reply to our communication to the Soviet Foreign Office.

When asked to comment upon the Pravda editorial on this action, the Secretary said he had seen the editorial and thought it unnecessary to comment on it. He went on to say that the only thing that stood out in his mind was the allegation that the action of the Security Council was illegal because of the absence of the Soviet representative, and because the representative of China was not a Communist. The Secretary said we had pointed out many times that this was a totally unfounded view. He stated that the Security Council could not be frustrated and made wholly immobile by the willful absence of any of its members.

Secretary Acheson, when asked if we expected more than the moral support of some of the other powers in this situation, replied that the United Nations had asked all of its members to furnish support to the Government of South Korea. He said that what they would do was a matter for them, and not for him, to decide. He said he thought that world response to the action already taken indicated that those governments were fully behind that which was being done by the United Nations and the United States.

When a correspondent remarked that there was a report that the British had offered us ten ships for use in Korea, Mr. Acheson said this had not come to his attention.

Secretary Acheson, when asked if the decision which this Government had taken was likely to produce some new budget or appropriations requests to Congress of an emergency nature, replied that he could not answer, partly through lack of knowledge and partly because any such matter should come from the President through the Bureau of the Budget.

A correspondent referring to the fact that we still recognized the Nationalist Government and Chiang as the authorized Government for China and assuming that Chiang still had the right to aid his own people on the mainland, asked what had prompted the United States Government to include in this

directive the statements regarding Chiang, literally forbidding him to go to the mainland. Secretary Acheson replied that the correspondent had given a somewhat different view of President's statement than the one he himself had received. He then read from the statement:

> "The attack upon Korea makes it plain beyond all doubt that Communism has passed beyond the use of subversion to conquer independent nations and will now use armed invasion and war. It has defied the orders of the Security Council of the United Nations issued to preserve international peace and security. In these circumstances the occupation of Formosa by Communist forces would be a direct threat to the security of the Pacific area and to United States forces performing their lawful and necessary function in that area.
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> "Accordingly I have ordered the Seventh Fleet to prevent any attack on Formosa. As a corollary of this action I am calling upon the Chinese Government on Formosa to cease all air and sea operations against the mainland. The Seventh Fleet will see that this is done. The determination of the future status of Formosa must await the restoration of security in the Pacific, a peace settlement with Japan, or consideration by the United Nations."

The Secretary said that what the President had stressed was that the action taken by the Communist North Korean Government had defied the orders of the Security Council of the United Nations issued to preserve international peace and security. The Secretary, referring to the part, "In these circumstances the occupation of Formosa by Communist forces would be a direct threat to the security of the Pacific area", said that here again the President had showed his interest in peace under the security of the United States forces. Therefore, said the Secretary, the President had ordered the Seventh Fleet to prevent an attack on Formosa, and to prevent an attack by Formosa against anybody else. Mr. Acheson said that, obviously, if you were restoring peace and security, you restored it by restoring peace. He pointed out that you could not say that one group of people could not attack a second group, but that the second group could attack the first group. That, he said, would make no sense if you were trying to restore peace and security.

The Secretary was then asked if the last sentence he read about the future of Formosa changed in any way the statement made at the Cairo Conference about the future of Formosa. He replied that it was related to a different thing, that it stated that the future status of it should be determined in that way. He said that the Cairo Declaration was the views of those who made the Declaration as to what the status would be. Mr. Acheson said that he thought that what the President made clear was that his action was not intended to determine the future status of Formosa.

Secretary Acheson, when asked if developments since Sunday meant that we have moved from a "cold" war to a "hot" war with communism, said he could not answer a question in that way. He said the facts of the situation were plain, and he thought that the correspondent could draw his own conclusion from them. He went on to say that we were now engaged in supporting the resolution of the United Nations Security Council in Korea, and in doing that the United States Government under the direction of the President was employing its forces.

A correspondent remarked that there had been some reports that we had not given Korea any aid for two years although there were funds available for it. He asked if this were true. The Secretary replied that he was sure it was not true, but that he did not have the figures with him. He said that a great deal of material had been sent to Korea, but when and of what nature he could not say.

When asked if the so-called North Korean Government had any international standing, the Secretary replied in the negative. When a correspondent remarked that the North Korean Government was legally just a gang of armed marauders which had possession of a certain amount of territory, the Secretary responded in the affirmative.

The Secretary was asked if the comment that our actions in respect to Indo-China and the Philippines was also taken under the aegis of the United Nations was correct. Mr. Acheson said they grew out of this action. Obviously, he said, they were not called for by the United Nations. He went on to say that it was perfectly plain that if we did not take action to preserve peace and security in those areas they would be disturbed very soon, therefore, that action had been taken.

When asked if it would be fair to assume that there was as definite a line in those regions as there was now in the Pacific, the Secretary replied that he did not wish to interpret the President's statement, adding that he felt that it was clear enough.

A correspondent mentioned the Secretary's reference to the counsels given the President and the working papers, or memoranda, or decisions, or advice that both the State and Defense Departments were able to give the President very quickly and promptly on the Korean matter and asked if there was at any time any doubt that in this area of the world the Russians, if they choose to use it, had immediate military superiority. The Secretary said he did not want to get into any speculation or talk about the Soviet Union. He said we were now dealing with the question of attack by the North Korean forces, with the possibilities of attacks on Formosa by the Chinese Communist forces, with the possibilities of difficulties in Indo-China, either created by Ho Chi-Minh or by Ho Chi-Minh plus outside support. Again he said he did not wish to discuss the Soviet Union in this connection nor did he wish to pose as a military expert who would know the answer to this question.

A correspondent referred to Senator Lucas' calling our action in regard to the Philippines and Formosa "unilateral" and making a distinction between that and the action in Korea. Secretary Acheson said he had just made that same distinction. He said that what we were doing in Korea was directly under a resolution passed by the Security Council. He said what we were doing in other areas was taking action which was made necessary by the obvious determination of Communist Governments in the Far East to progress beyond subversion to direct military attack. He explained that in this way it was done by us and not at the request of anybody else.

When asked if the language of the President's statement about Formosa permitted the implication that that was done under Article 51, the right of individual self-defense, the Secretary replied that he thought that was understandable.

Lincoln White.

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